

Supplier Code of Conduct

Document Information

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 - **Title:** Supplier Code of Conduct
 - **Version:** 2.1
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1. Purpose

This Supplier Code of Conduct establishes the ethical, social, and environmental standards that all suppliers, contractors, and business partners of Acme Corporation must adhere to as a condition of doing business.

2. Scope

This Code applies to all suppliers, subcontractors, agents, and business partners providing goods or services to Acme Corporation anywhere in the world. Suppliers are responsible for flowing down these requirements to their own supply chain.

3. Compliance with Laws

All suppliers shall comply with all applicable laws and regulations in the countries where they operate. This includes but is not limited to labor laws, environmental regulations, anti-corruption laws, and trade sanctions.

4. Labor and Human Rights

4.1 Forced Labor

Forced, bonded, or indentured labor is strictly prohibited. All work shall be voluntary, and workers shall have the freedom to leave employment with reasonable notice.

4.2 Child Labor

Child labor is strictly prohibited. No person under the minimum legal working age or under 15 years of age (whichever is higher) shall be employed.

4.3 Working Hours

Working hours shall comply with applicable laws and industry standards. Overtime shall be voluntary and compensated at the legally required rate.

4.4 Wages and Benefits

Workers shall be paid at least the minimum legal wage. All legally mandated benefits shall be provided. Wage deductions not required by law shall require worker consent.

4.5 Discrimination and Harassment

A workplace free from discrimination, harassment, and retaliation shall be maintained. Employment decisions shall be based on merit and qualification.

4.6 Freedom of Association

Workers shall have the right to join or form trade unions and to bargain collectively in accordance with local laws.

5. Health and Safety

5.1 Safe Workplace

A safe and healthy work environment shall be provided. Suppliers shall implement effective safety management systems including hazard identification, risk assessment, and incident investigation.

5.2 Emergency Preparedness

Emergency plans, evacuation procedures, and fire safety equipment shall be in place and tested regularly.

5.3 Occupational Health

Occupational health services shall be provided, including medical surveillance for hazardous exposures.

6. Environment

6.1 Environmental Compliance

All applicable environmental laws and regulations shall be complied with. Environmental permits shall be obtained and maintained.

6.2 Pollution Prevention

Suppliers shall implement pollution prevention measures including waste minimization, emissions control, and wastewater treatment.

6.3 Climate Change

Suppliers shall measure and report greenhouse gas emissions. Carbon reduction targets shall be established and progress reported annually.

6.4 Hazardous Substances

Hazardous substances shall be managed, stored, transported, and disposed of in accordance with applicable regulations.

7. Business Integrity

7.1 Anti-Corruption

Corruption, bribery, kickbacks, and improper payments are strictly prohibited. No supplier shall offer or provide anything of value to influence business decisions.

7.2 Gifts and Entertainment

Gifts and entertainment shall be reasonable and customary. Cash or cash equivalents shall never be offered to Acme employees.

7.3 Conflicts of Interest

Suppliers shall disclose any actual or potential conflicts of interest with Acme Corporation employees.

7.4 Confidentiality

Supplier shall protect Acme Corporation's confidential information and use it solely for the purpose of the business relationship.

8. Monitoring and Enforcement

8.1 Self-Assessment

Suppliers shall complete an annual self-assessment confirming compliance with this Code.

8.2 Audits

Acme Corporation reserves the right to audit supplier facilities to verify compliance. Notice of at least 30 days shall be provided for scheduled audits.

8.3 Non-Compliance

Non-compliance shall result in a Corrective Action Request. Persistent or severe non-compliance may result in suspension, contract termination, and removal from the Approved Supplier List.

9. Reporting

Violations of this Code may be reported confidentially through the Acme Corporation Ethics Hotline. No retaliation shall be taken against any person reporting a concern in good faith.

10. Related Documents

- PROC-012: Vendor Qualification and Evaluation
- PROC-042: Contract Management Procedure
- LEG-002: Anti-Corruption Policy
- ENV-001: Environmental Policy